

Ethan Mathews

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EDUCATION

Master of Environmental Data Science, 4.0 GPA (Expected June 2027)

Bren School of Environmental Science & Management – University of California, Santa Barbara (UCSB)

Highlighted Coursework: TBD

Leadership/Involvement: Bren Class Chair Committee

Bachelor of Arts in Environmental Studies, 3.98 GPA (June 2025)

University of California, Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara, CA

Honors/Awards: Highest honors – Summa cum laude

Leadership/Involvement: Member of Environmental Agency Board, and UCSB Environmental Law Club.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant (11/2025–Present)

Perrone Lab, Santa Barbara, CA

- Reviewed Kansas groundwater administrative policies from the 1980s–1990s to trace the evolution of regulatory controls affecting basin management and water availability.
- Analyzed primary-source administrative procedures and statutory citations to determine relevance, scope, and legal implications for groundwater permitting.
- Built a structured, multi-variable database tracking policy iterations, amendments, supersessions, and basin-specific effects across 25+ administrative procedures.

Undergraduate Research Assistant (12/2024–11/2025)

PhD Candidate Kelly Garvey, Santa Barbara, CA

- Collected drilling practice, pricing, and materials data from 1,500+ well drillers via outreach, informing research on county-level cost variation driven by lithology.
- Merged, cleaned, and visualized datasets of 200,000–1,000,000 observations from the California Open Data Portal using Python in Google Colab, supporting an interactive public database.
- Scraped and compiled federal and state agency data to characterize injection wells nationwide, supporting analysis of permitting trends and geospatial patterns.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Manager – Encinitas Fish Shop, Encinitas, CA (June 2021–Present)

- Managed 20 employees over 5–8-hour work shifts in a 36-table, fast-paced culinary setting having been promoted to a management position within the first year of employment.
- Prioritizing customer satisfaction by managing a dynamic and high-pressure setting and achieving daily sales exceeding \$25,000.
- Navigating challenging customer interactions and restaurant incidents, sharpening expertise in conflict resolution and the diplomatic management of difficult situations.
- Collaborating with management team to improve team efficiency by reinforcing procedural compliance and optimizing staff performance, resulting in a reduction of labor costs from 25% to 10.5%-12.5%.

SKILLS

Technical Skills: R, Python, SQL, Git/GitHub, ArcGIS, Microsoft Office (Excel, Word)

Languages: Spanish (Intermediate)

Certifications: TBD

Affiliations: Member of the National Ground Water Association